MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Platform Engineering

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines and test infrastructure for three product teams. Improved pipeline runtime from 38 to 14 minutes and built short-lived, merge-request test environments deployed to a shared Kubernetes cluster. Experienced with GitLab CI, Docker, Helm, Python and Bash, with hands-on design of repeatable test-environment workflows, observability for CI quality, and documentation used for team onboarding. Additional personal project experience provisioning infrastructure using Terraform and operating a k3s homelab with GitOps and monitoring. Currently studying for the Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) exam.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Infrastructure & CI/CD: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Terraform (personal Hetzner project), GitOps with Argo CD
Containers & Linux: Kubernetes (namespace-level access; Helm deployments to shared cluster), k3s, Linux
Monitoring, Ingress & TLS: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Traefik, cert-manager, TLS
Programming & Data: Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, PostgreSQL
Testing: pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman
Cloud learning: AWS EC2 and S3 basics

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software *2021–Present*

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (approximately 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, as well as artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into a dedicated stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by approximately 30%.
- Designed and built merge-request ephemeral environments containing the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data; deployed them via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI, enabling QA and product teams to review features and run end-to-end tests before merge.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of approximately 900 tests; reduced the flaky test rate from 7% to below 2%.
- Developed Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and a Python/GitLab API workflow that collects CI results into PostgreSQL for Grafana flaky-test dashboards.
- Documented the CI system in an internal guide used for team onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Set up Prometheus, Grafana and Loki monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS.
- Provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS using Terraform; used Ansible at a basic level.

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Delivered short-lived application and PostgreSQL environments with seeded data for merge requests, deployed through GitLab CI and Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against the environments.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end testing into a separate stage; reduced average runtime from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by approximately 30%.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018
ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — studying; exam booked for January 2027

LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)